

An abstract background graphic featuring flowing, translucent blue and purple ribbons and bands that create a sense of motion and depth. The background is a dark gradient of blue and purple.

dmg::media

Powering dmg::media's
Cloud Transformation
with Confidence

A clear, proven path to scalable cloud success

How Microsoft's Platform Directly Delivers dmg's Priority Outcomes



Standardisation

Azure as the foundation

- A single, policy-driven platform for all brands - dmg can operate consistently across its portfolio, reducing fragmentation while still allowing individual brands to innovate within clear guardrails
- Approved landing zones and repeatable patterns reduce sprawl - New environments can be stood up faster and more predictably, lowering setup time and avoiding the long-term cost and risk of ad-hoc architectures
- Governance, security, and cost controls built in by design - Compliance and financial discipline are enforced automatically, reducing operational risk and avoiding retrofitting controls later under pressure.



Productivity

Fabric + automation

- One unified analytics platform (Fabric + OneLake) - dmg teams work from a single, trusted data foundation, eliminating duplication, reconciliation overhead, and conflicting insights across the organisation.
- Automation-first delivery removes manual effort and rework - Engineering and data teams spend more time on value-adding work, not repetitive operational tasks, increasing overall delivery capacity.
- Faster insight, experimentation, and time-to-value - dmg can test, learn, and respond to audience and commercial signals more quickly, improving decision-making speed in a fast-moving media environment.



Risk Reduction

Security + UK-native resilience

- Integrated Zero Trust security across identity, data, and workloads - Security is consistently applied across all platforms and teams, reducing the likelihood and blast radius of security incidents
- UK-native disaster recovery (UK South / UK West) - dmg meets UK data residency and resilience expectations while maintaining continuity for critical services in the event of regional failure
- Repeatable resilience patterns, not bespoke designs per workload - Resilience becomes a standard capability rather than a bespoke cost, improving reliability while reducing design complexity and long-term support burden.

Bottom line: Azure provides dmg with a standardised, secure, and automation-ready platform that reduces risk today and accelerates outcomes over time.

Content

-  Azure Foundations & First Steps Roll Out
-  Data, Analytics & AI Advantage
-  Security & Trust Embedded
-  Operating Model & Delivery
-  Cost Control & Commercial Optimisation
-  Partnership, Skills & Co-Innovation
-  Outcomes & Success Measures
-  Funding & Support Programs

Azure: Standardised Foundation

Azure is the control plane for standardisation, governance, and repeatability across dmj media's operating model.

STANDARDISATION APPROACH

- Converge on a small set of approved landing patterns to reduce platform sprawl and simplify delivery across brands.
- Embed security, compliance and governance by default with policy guardrails, standard network patterns, and identity-first access.
- Enable repeatable environment builds via blueprints and templates to remove low-value bespoke work.
- Adopt an automation-first approach (IaC, self-service) to reduce operational toil and key-person dependency.
- Provides the foundation to layer data, AI and security capabilities without creating a new silo.

Capability Layers



Security and Compliance



Data and AI



Operations and FinOps



Azure Platform Foundation

Landing zones, governance, identity, networking

No-Regrets First Steps



Day 0

Design

- Establish Azure Landing Zone with policy-driven governance, identity integration, and shared services
- Define approved patterns for common workload types (VMware, VMs, containers, data platforms)



Day 1

Deploy

- Stand up shared security baseline (Defender/Sentinel, secure access, key management)
- Introduce cost guardrails early (tagging standards, budgets, showback, optimisation routines)



Day 2

Operate

- Use discovery outputs to prioritise migration waves and identify modernisation candidates
- Continuously refine patterns and operational practices based on real workload feedback

Pragmatic early actions deliver control and confidence quickly, without requiring a disruptive big-bang migration.

UK/EU Footprint and Resilience

Azure's UK and EU region footprint directly addresses dmG's data residency and resilience requirements with transparent, repeatable patterns.

- Design for mandated UK data residency with London as the primary region, and clear options for EU workloads.
- Support resilient architectures using paired-region patterns and clear DR choices (including UK West).
- Make resilience a repeatable pattern with reference architectures and standard runbooks.
- Provide transparent operating and incident management processes.



UK-Native Resilience by Design

Azure uniquely enables same-country disaster recovery for UK-hosted workloads, delivering resilience without compromising data residency.

What this means for dmG

- UK South → UK West is a first-class paired-region pattern
Designed into Azure's regional architecture, enabling disaster recovery within the UK rather than relying on cross-border failover.
- Resilience without regulatory trade-offs
Disaster recovery can be achieved without moving data outside the UK, simplifying data residency, legal review, and governance.
- Clear, repeatable DR architectures
Azure provides reference patterns for active/passive and active/active designs using UK South as primary and UK West as recovery.
- Operationally realistic recovery, not theoretical resilience
Testing, runbooks, and automation can be standardised once and reused across workloads, rather than bespoke DR per application.



Microsoft Fabric: a Unified Analytics Platform on Azure

The infrastructure decision unlocks a future-ready unified analytics platform -- Azure plus Fabric eliminates data fragmentation and accelerates time-to-insight.

Microsoft Fabric is Microsoft's end-to-end, SaaS analytics platform — bringing data ingestion, engineering, warehousing, real-time analytics, data science, and BI together on a single shared data foundation.

- Fabric sits above Azure infrastructure as a single analytics platform — It replaces fragmented tools with one integrated SaaS experience.
- OneLake is Fabric's shared data foundation — Analytics data is landed once and reused across all Fabric workloads.
- All analytics workloads run on Fabric — not alongside it — Data Engineering, Data Warehousing, Real-Time Analytics, Data Science, and Power BI all operate on the same platform and data.
- Governance, security, and identity are applied once — Policies, access controls, and lineage are consistent across every analytics workload.



Unlike traditional analytics stacks, Fabric is one platform — not a collection of integrated services.

OneLake Shortcuts and Mirroring

Fabric enables dmgs to bring data to OneLake without a massive lift-and-shift, using shortcuts and mirroring to start delivering value immediately.

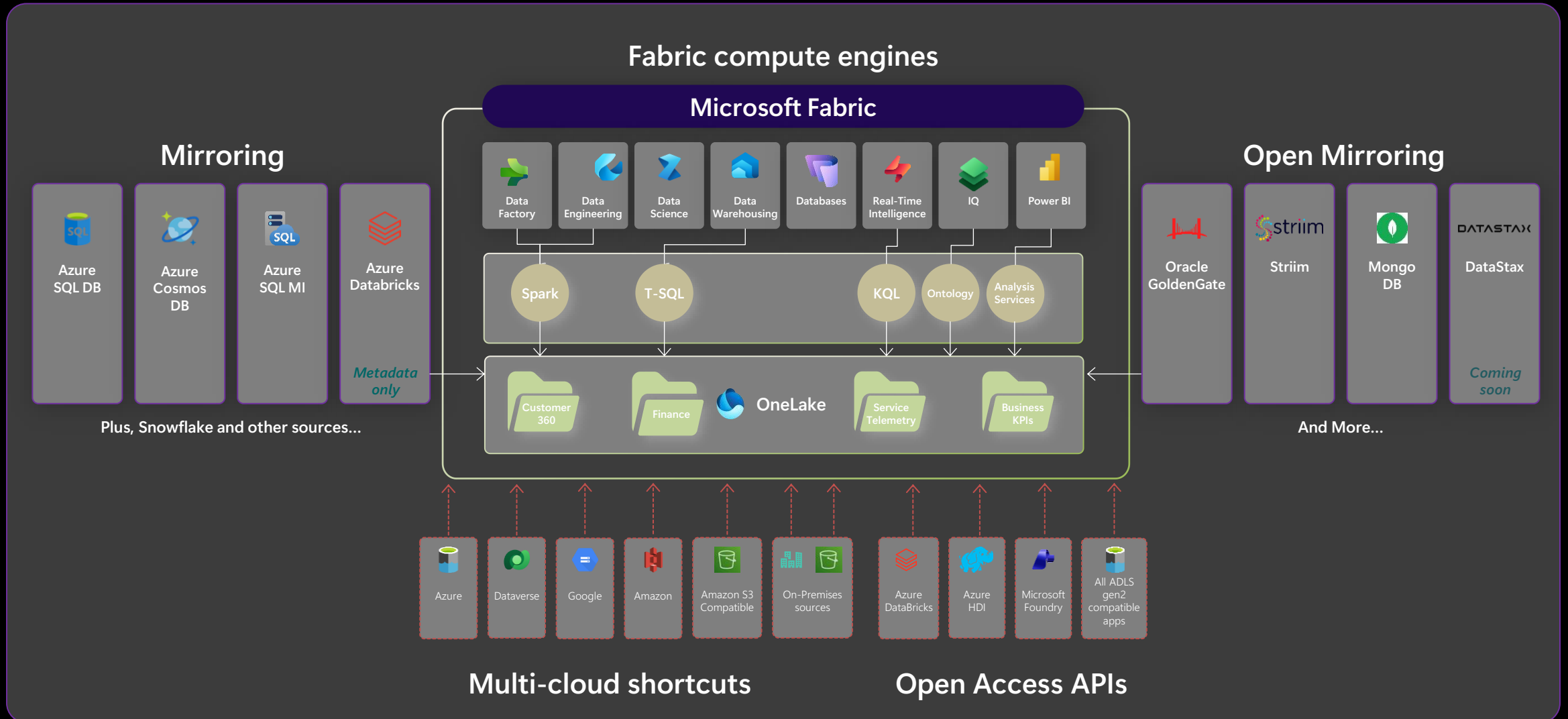


⚡ Start with highest-value datasets and standardise access patterns early

🧪 Enable faster prototyping of analytics and AI use cases in parallel with migration

OneLake Shortcuts and Mirroring

Fabric enables dmgs to bring data to OneLake without a massive lift-and-shift, using shortcuts and mirroring to start delivering value immediately.

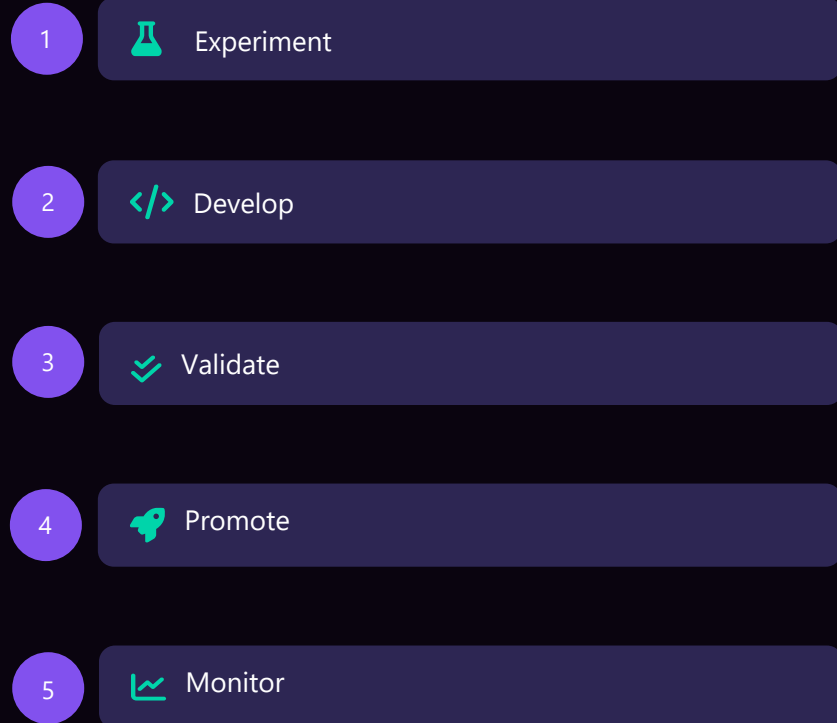


AI-Ready by Design

A unified, governed data foundation accelerates AI adoption while maintaining the control and requirements for responsible use.

- Enable AI initiatives with a single, governed data foundation.
- Support responsible adoption: clearly separated environments, controlled access, and auditable data usage.
- Move from experimentation to repeatable delivery: standard pipelines, version control, and promotion.
- Align AI initiatives to the company's automation and productivity goals.

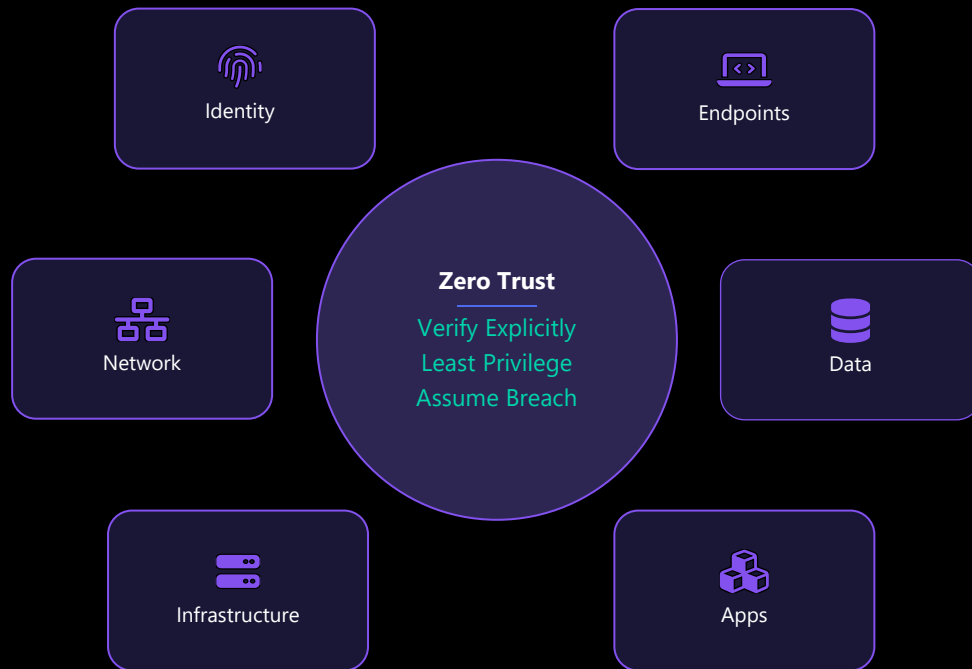
Governed AI Lifecycle



 **Governance Guardrails Across All Stages**

Integrated Security Posture

Microsoft's integrated security platform delivers a consistent Zero Trust approach across identities, workloads, and data, reducing integration overhead.



- Apply a consistent Zero Trust approach across identities, endpoints, infrastructure and data
- Reduce integration overhead by using a single security platform spanning detection, investigation and response
- Standardise identity and access controls using a single policy model
- Extend data governance and protection consistently across analytics and collaboration workloads

SOC Integration and Response

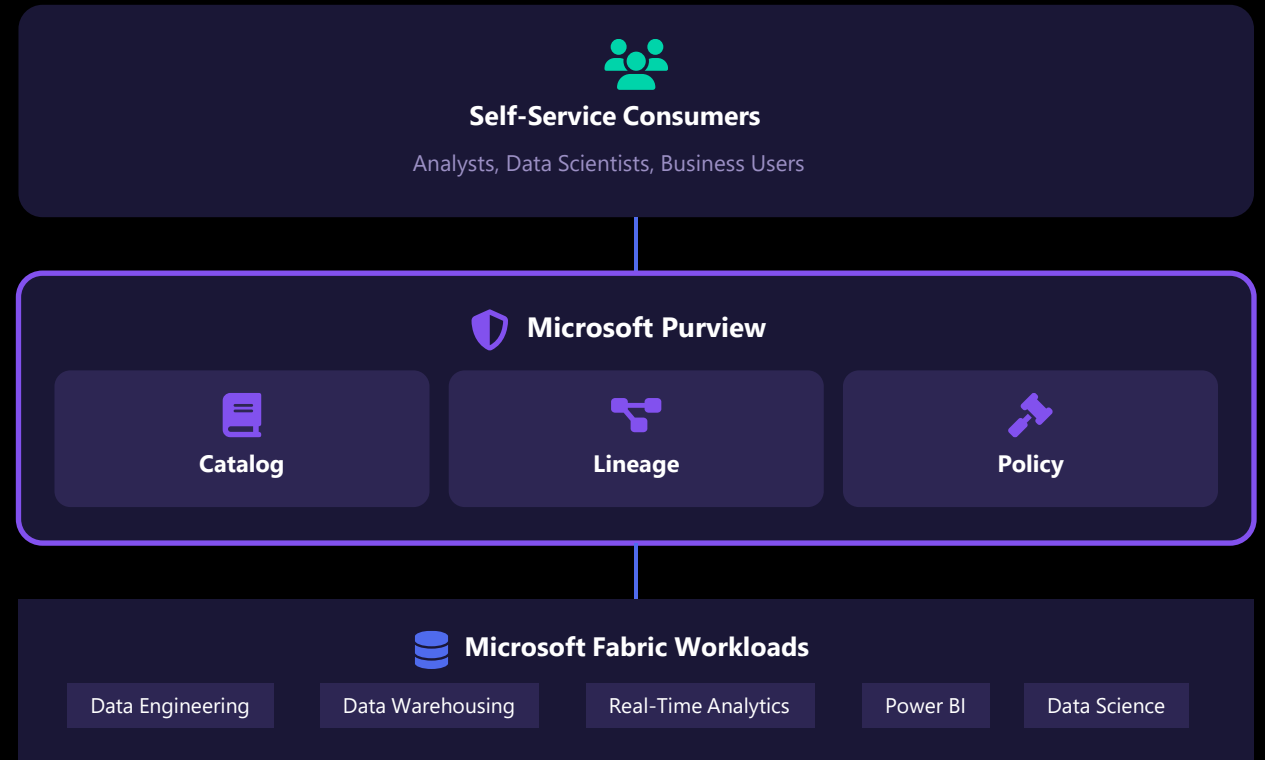
An integrated security estate supports scalable Day 2 operations with centralised monitoring, detection, and transparent incident response.



Data Governance with Purview

Purview plus Fabric delivers integrated lineage, cataloguing, and policy enforcement so dmgs can enable self-service analytics without losing control.

- Establish a searchable data catalogue and lineage to make data discoverable, trusted, and auditable.
- Apply consistent sensitivity labelling and data loss prevention policies.
- Reduce governance overhead by leveraging platform-native metadata and activity logs.
- Enable self-service analytics without losing control.



Day 0/1/2 Operating Model

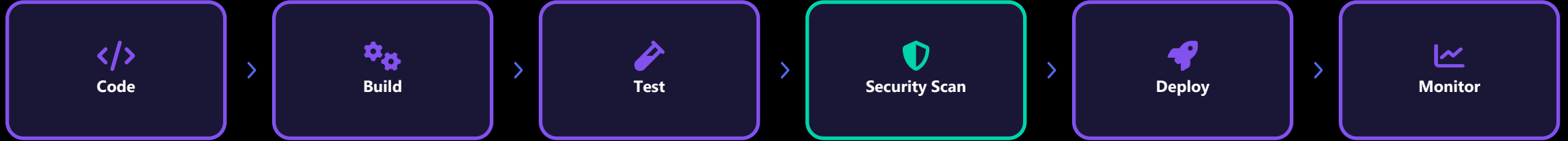
A structured operating model with clear responsibilities across design, deploy, and operate phases replaces heroic individual effort with consistent, scalable practices.

	Day 0 Design	Day 1 Deploy	Day 2 Operate & Optimise
 dmg	- Define governance and policies - Approve landing zone patterns	- Validate workload migration waves - Adopt policy-driven controls	- Single operational view - Reduce shadow IT
 Rackspace	- Co-design landing zone architecture - Define approved workload patterns	- Deploy and automate infrastructure - Execute migration waves	- Automate patching, backup, scaling - Managed services operations
 Microsoft	- Provide reference architectures - Advisory on best practices	- Platform enablement support - Toolchain and service integration	- Roadmap and service evolution - Ongoing optimisation guidance

Automation-First Delivery

Standardised templates, IaC, and self-service with guardrails let product teams move faster while security remains embedded in the delivery system.

Security & Compliance Guardrails



Policy-Driven Golden Path



Infrastructure as Code

Standardise deployments through reusable modules and templates



Self-Service with Guardrails

Product teams move faster without creating risk



Integrated DevOps Pipelines

Unified toolchains and deployment pipelines across teams



Embedded DevSecOps

Security is part of the delivery system, not a gate at the end

Cost Governance by Design

Cost management becomes a first-class operational capability with workload-level transparency, accountability, and a regular FinOps rhythm.



- Provide workload-level cost transparency with tagging standards, showback/chargeback, and budget controls
- Establish a regular FinOps rhythm shared across dmG, Rackspace and Microsoft
- Use actionable optimisation recommendations to continuously right-size and reduce waste
- Make cost a design input through guardrails and reference patterns

Commercial Levers for TCO

A combination of license portability, reservations, savings plans, and committed-spend constructs reduces effective TCO without restricting agility.



Licence Portability

Optimise hybrid scenarios using licence portability and Azure Hybrid Benefit to maximise existing investments.



Reservations & Savings Plans

Improve cost predictability with reservations and savings plans that lock in discounted rates for committed usage.



Committed Spend (MACC)

Align large-scale migration plans to committed-spend constructs for maximum commercial advantage.



FinOps Governance

Combine commercial levers with FinOps governance so savings are realised and sustained over time.

Option A: Lift-and-shift

- Option A provides an estimate for a strict, like-for-like re-host (lift-and-shift) response aligned directly to the snapshot dataset supplied by dmg, with no optimisation or architectural changes assumed.* (Assumptions shared in slide 21)
- Pricing is based on Azure Reserved Instances for steady-state workloads to deliver the strongest commercial outcome, while retaining flexibility through reservation exchange options should requirements evolve over time.

Option A - 3 Yr Reservation Instances		
Total Cost for each region (Compute + Disk + DB)	Monthly	Annual
UK South	\$ 171,520.69	\$ 2,058,248.28
North Europe	\$ 162,525.31	\$ 1,950,303.72
Germany West Central	\$ 161,325.66	\$ 1,935,907.92

- Please review the following document for more details on the ability to exchange Azure Reservations. [Self-service exchanges and refunds for Azure Reservations - Microsoft Cost Management | Microsoft Learn](#)

* An assessment will need to be completed using Azure Migrate or Dr Migrate within the environment for full performance history and to refine cost estimate

Option B: Microsoft Azure Consumption Commitment (MACC)

- Option B models a typical enterprise setup, blending commitment-based discounts with on-demand flexibility—using 30% Pay-as-you-go and 70% Reserved instances to reflect typical enterprise cost profiles*. (See slide 21 for assumptions.)
- \$8.7M Milestone MACC Over 3 years contracted under the Microsoft Customer Agreement (MCA);
 - \$1.7m is current consumption + \$7m is the estimated cost to virtualise dmg’s infrastructure estate.
- Azure Commitment Discount (ACD)
 - In return for the MACC over 3 years, MSFT will provide an 8% discount on all pay as you go 1st party services, including DMGs current workloads. ACD does not apply to Reserved Instances (RIs).
- Below is an illustration of the optimised costs across different regions.

Option B (30% PAYG + 70% RIs)		
Region	Monthly	Annually
UK South	\$ 218,999.63	\$ 2,627,995.60
North Europe	\$ 199,654.84	\$ 2,395,858.05
Germany West Central	\$ 206,053.05	\$ 2,472,636.57

- Azure commitments are aligned with adoption and optimisation services, delivered through **Unified**, to accelerate deployment and maximise value from the MACC. All MACCs must have a Unified attached. Details shared separately.

* An assessment will need to be completed using Azure Migrate or Dr Migrate within the environment for full performance history and to refine cost estimate

Additional Details on MACC

Microsoft Azure Consumption Commitment

Disclaimer: This guide is intended to provide an understanding of how the Microsoft Azure Consumption Commitment (MACC) is licensed. This guide does not supersede or replace any of the legal documentation around MACC. Specific terms are defined in the MACC amendment. This licensing guide is not a legal use rights document. Program specifications and business rules are subject to change.

What is the Microsoft Azure Consumption Commitment

Azure Platform Commitment

Contractual Commitment to Spend on Azure Over Time
NO UPFRONT PAYMENT REQUIRED & INTERIM COMMITMENT TARGETS*

What Spend Counts Towards the Commitment

Azure Service Consumption

Azure Marketplace Purchases**

RI Purchases & Payments

Azure Prepayments***



Eligible Spend

- Azure Service Consumption
- Reservations, Savings Plans, and 3P software plans
- Azure Prepayment
- SAP Hana Large instances
- 1PP/3PP IP Co-sell incentivized apps



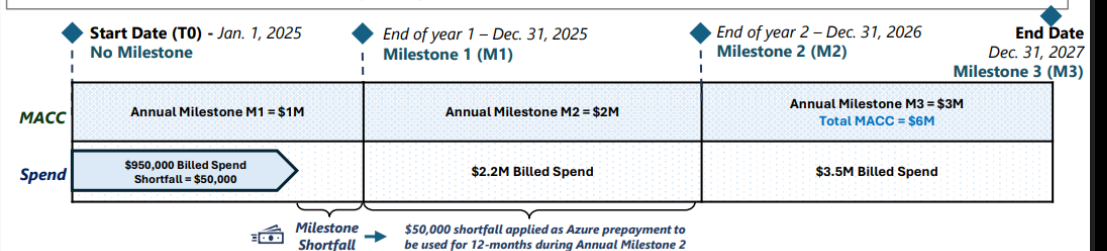
How it decrements commitments

- Each month's Azure invoice
- The billed amount on each invoice
- The full amount of any Azure Prepayment purchase
- The full purchased amount
- Azure Marketplace invoices

*Interim milestones are only available in MCA **Limited to eligible offers ***Monetary commitment renamed to Azure prepayment.

How the Microsoft Azure Consumption Commitment Works

Disclaimer: This is an illustrative example only.



Frequently asked questions

Question: What happens if I fall short of any milestone target? – also known as a “shortfall.”

Answer: Any milestone that ends with a shortfall will be billed for the missed amount as an Azure prepayment. The Azure prepayment will be invoiced per your standard payment terms and will have a 12-month period to be used.

Question: What if I spend more than anticipated within a milestone target?

Answer: If you spend more than your milestone during that period, it will decrement your commitment for the following milestone target.

Question: How do I check where I am with respect to achieving my MACC annual milestone?

Answer: You can see your milestone progress in your Azure portal. Additionally, you will receive notifications at 90, 60 and 30 days if you are at risk of shortfall.



MACC Investment Levers

Investments

Direct Investment	ECIF (End Customer Investment Funding)	ACO (Azure Credit Offer)	ACD (Azure Commitment Discount)
Foundation	A Consumption Plan		
	B Deal Term Length		
	C Spend Commitment: MACC		

Definitions

Acceleration of workload migration to Azure	Offset "early in life" double run costs or ramp-up costs	Incentivize future workload migration and reduce Azure costs
A Customer & MS <u>aligned</u> plan for growth on Azure		
B 3 years		
C Achievable growth underpinned by Consumption Plan		

This is not an offer and does not create binding commitments. Funding requires approval; this slide only informs DMG of potential investment options.
Final terms will be those in the executed Commercial Licensing Agreement.

Azure Consumption Assumptions

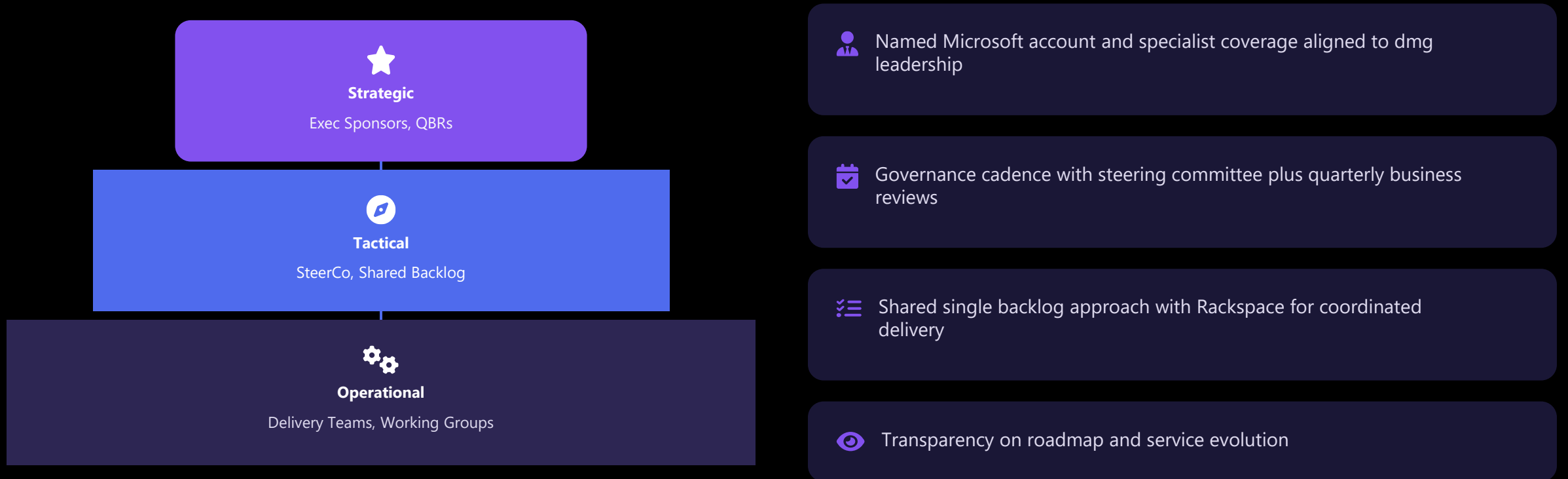
The following assumptions were made during the sizing of this:

- Workloads are deployed using Azure Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS).
- SQL Server workloads are hosted on Azure Virtual Machines, not PaaS services.
- VM sizing is based on source CPU cores and combined OS + SQL memory, with no aggressive right-sizing applied.
- Storage is modelled using separate managed disks for SQL data and transaction logs, in line with standard SQL Server on Azure IaaS deployment patterns.
- Azure Hybrid Benefit is assumed for Windows Server and SQL Server, where applicable.
- 3-Year Reserved Instances are used to represent steady-state consumption; PAYG pricing is used to represent ramp-up and flexibility.
- Managed disk reservations are not assumed and may be evaluated post-migration.
- Ancillary services (Azure Backup, Azure Monitor) have not been included in RFP requirements and therefore not within our costings at this stage, however, should be reassessed and costed in discovery workshops to ensure optimised resiliency of solution.
- Option B includes a ratio of using 30% of the Pay-as-you-go pricing, while utilising 70% of Reservation instances to showcase a typical Enterprise cost profile

*** An assessment will need to be completed using Azure Migrate or Dr Migrate within the environment for full performance history and to refine cost estimate**

Strategic Partnership Model

A named executive engagement model with structured governance cadence makes the Microsoft partnership tangible and accountable.



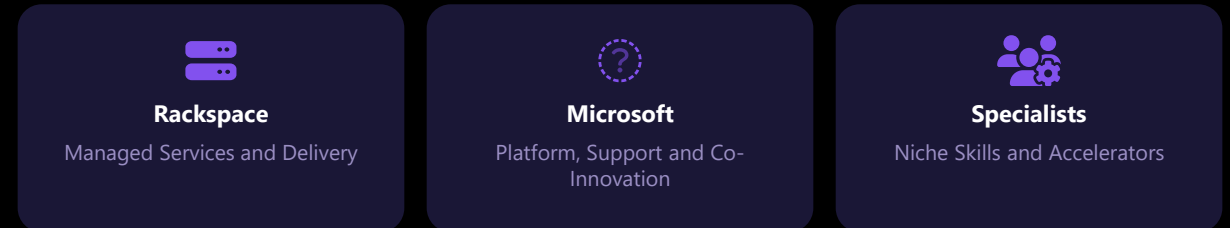
Ecosystem and Skills

Rackspace's delivery capability, a broad Azure partner ecosystem, and structured skilling reduce delivery risk and accelerate dmG's cloud maturity.



- Leverage Rackspace's delivery capability as an Azure-focused managed services partner
- Access a broad Azure partner ecosystem for specialist skills and accelerators
- Run a structured skilling plan to build internal capability within dmG teams
- Reduce delivery risk by using proven reference architectures and repeatable patterns

Partner Ecosystem



Commercial Skilling options

Designed for IT Pros, Developers, and Business Users

Scale Skilling for Everyone

Self-Paced Digital

- [Learn for Organizations](#)
- [Curated Plans on Learn](#)

Events & Workshops

- [Microsoft Virtual Training Days](#)
- [Learn Challenges](#)

Credentials

- [Certifications](#)
- [Applied Skills](#)
- [Practice Assessments](#)
- [Exam Readiness Zone](#)

Videos

- [Course Videos](#) for flexible learning



ESI Premium Skilling Options

Skilling Plan support across Microsoft's skilling ecosystem via Training Program Managers (TPMs)

Instructor-led Training (ILT) via Microsoft Technical Trainers (MTTs)

Training Services Partner vouchers (TSPs)

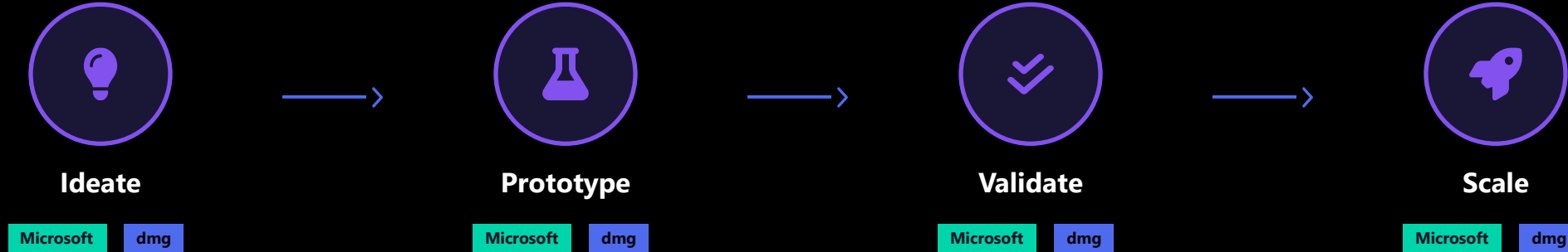
Learning portals (Learner Experience Portal, Customer Experience Portal)

Certification Discounts

24x7 ESI Support Desk for questions

Co-Innovation and Roadmap

dmg can increase innovation velocity on governed foundations without increasing platform sprawl, using structured preview programmes and co-designed patterns.



- Use structured preview and feedback programmes to access new capabilities early
- Co-design reference patterns for media workloads specific to dmG's portfolio
- Enable rapid prototyping on governed foundations so experimentation does not become technical debt
- Measure innovation outcomes as part of partnership governance

Microsoft Innovation Hub

From Defined Challenge to Proof of Value

Purpose: Accelerate delivery of real business and technical outcomes

Engagement style: Hands-on, outcome-driven collaboration

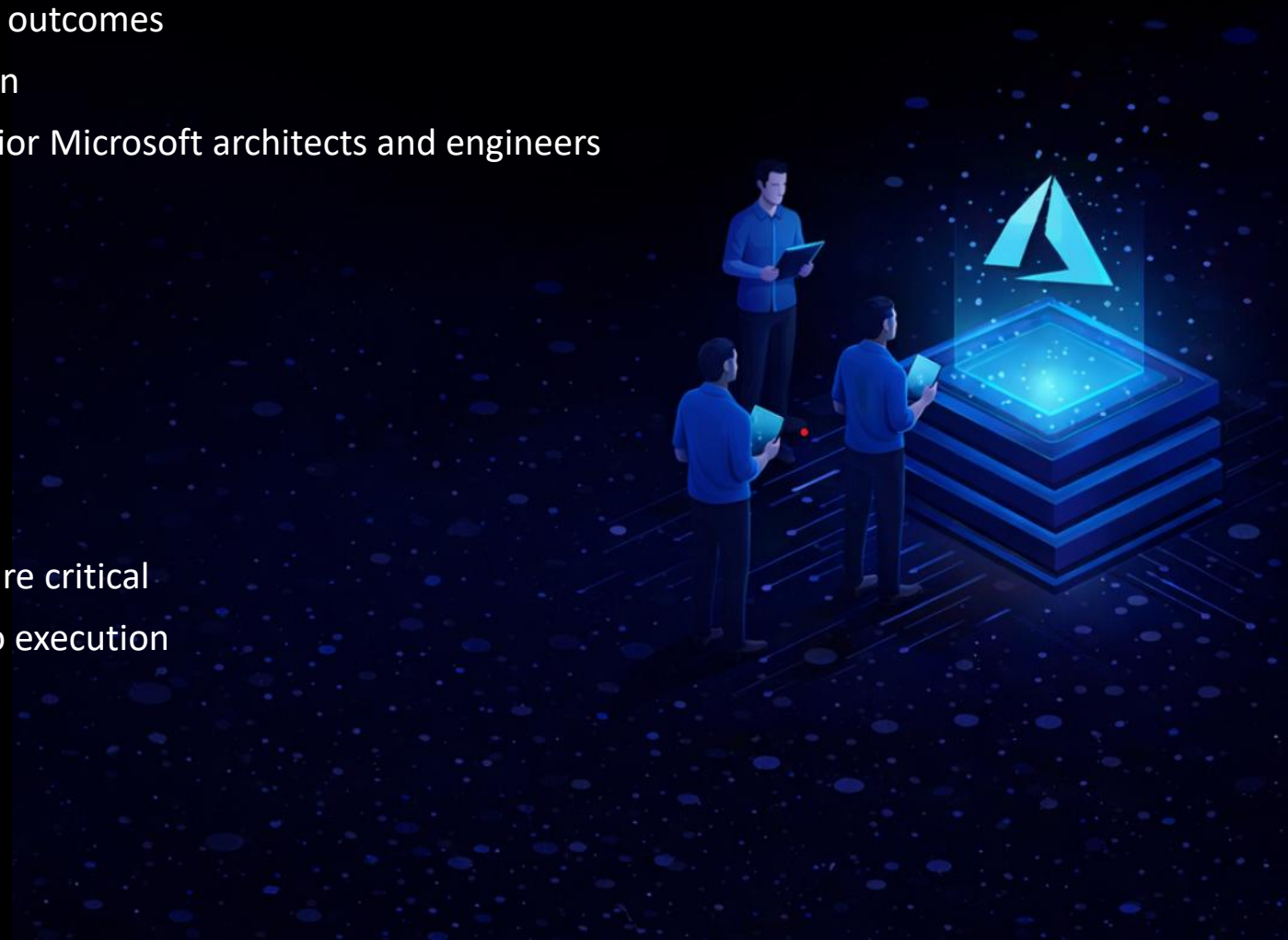
Who's involved: Customer teams working directly with senior Microsoft architects and engineers

What happens:

- Solution and architecture design
- Technical validation and risk reduction
- Rapid prototyping / proof of value on Azure

Best used when:

- A clear business or technical challenge is defined
- Speed, technical depth, and delivery confidence are critical
- The customer is ready to move beyond vision into execution



Microsoft Envisioning Centres

Strategic Vision, Alignment, and Direction

Purpose: Align senior leaders on future vision and strategic direction

Engagement style: Executive-led, immersive, and highly curated

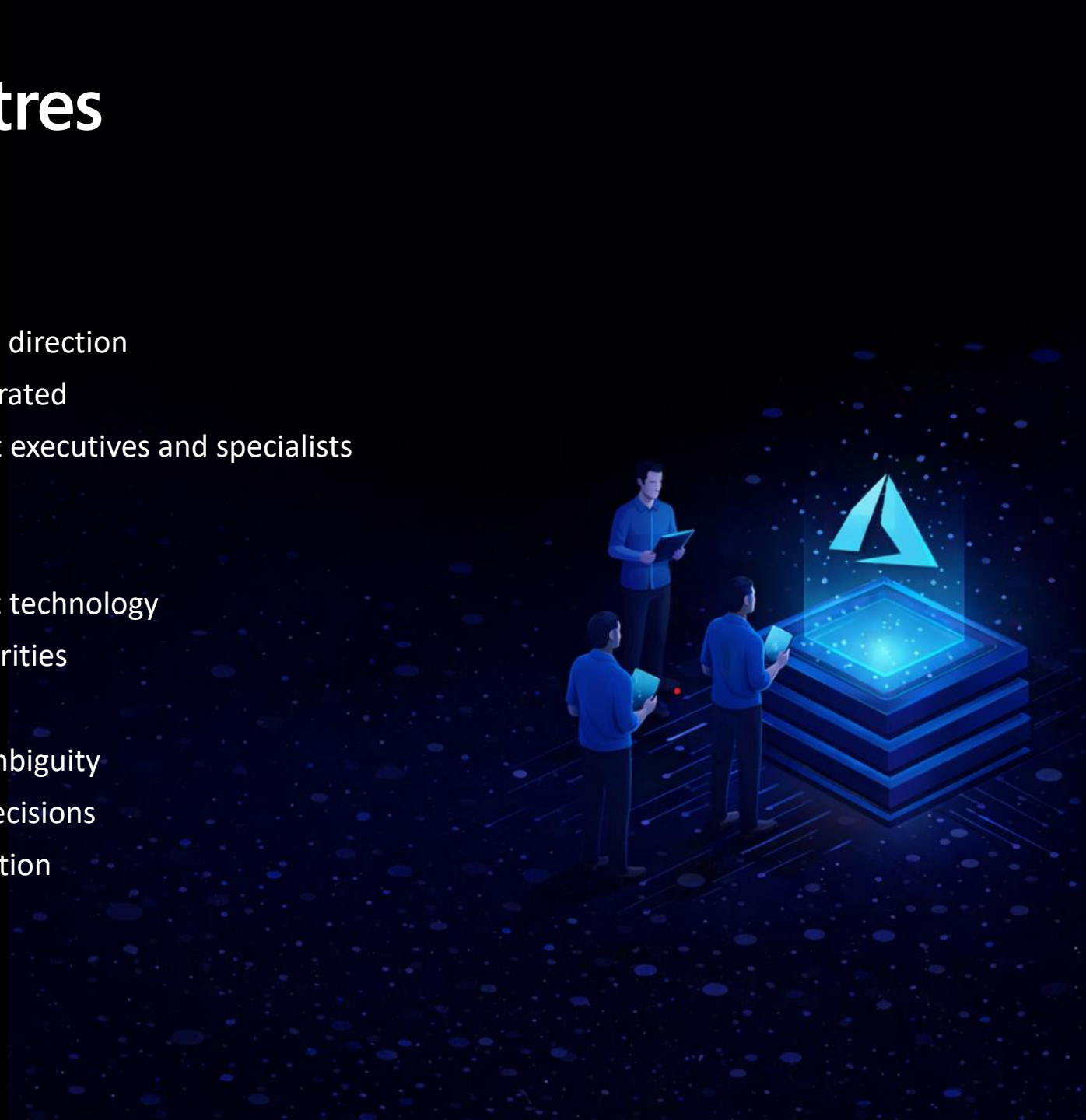
Who's involved: Customer leadership teams with Microsoft executives and specialists

What happens:

- Industry-specific storytelling and scenarios
- Demonstrations of what's possible with Microsoft technology
- Facilitated discussions to shape ambition and priorities

Best used when:

- The customer is early in their journey or facing ambiguity
- Executive alignment is needed before technical decisions
- The goal is to inspire, align, and frame transformation



Growth Levers to 1M Subs

Azure directly accelerates seven growth levers that help dmg reach the 1M subscriber milestone, from reliability at scale to unit economics discipline.

**Reliability and Performance at Scale**
Protect conversion and retention

**Faster Product Experimentation**
Increase conversion

**Unified Customer Data Foundation**
Increase acquisition and retention

**Personalisation and Recommendations**
Increase engagement and ARPU

**Marketing Measurement and Attribution**
Improve CAC efficiency

**Security and Trust**
Reduce churn and brand risk

**Cost / Unit Economics Discipline**
Fund growth sustainably



1M

Subscribers

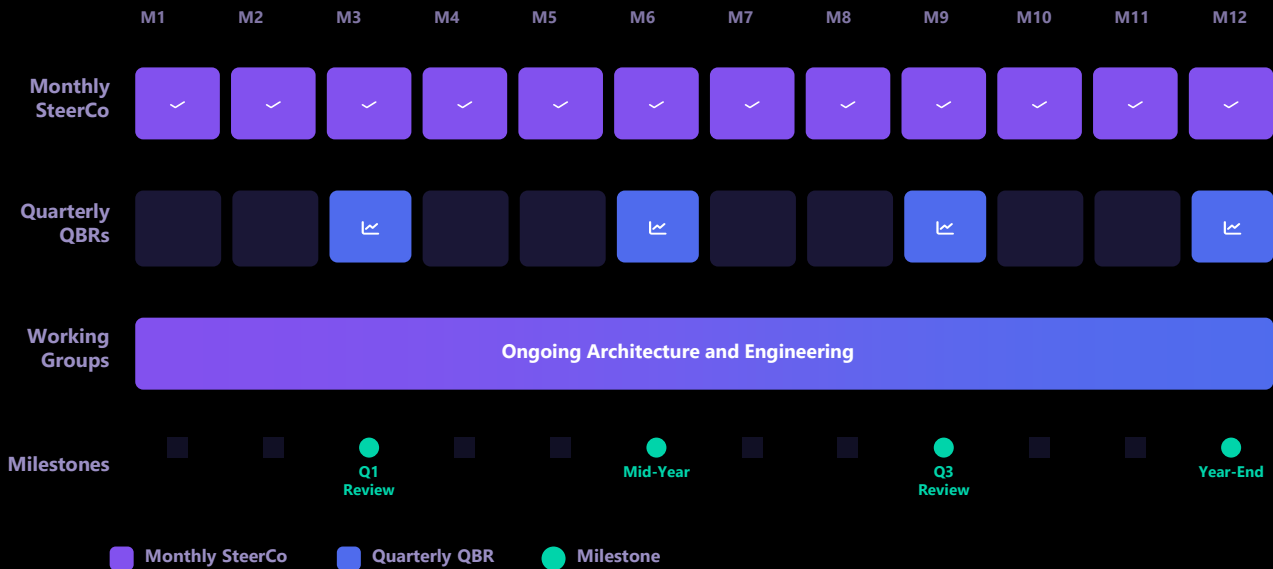
Growth Milestone
Powered by Azure

Executive Partnership Model

Microsoft stays committed for outcomes through named sponsors, monthly steering, quarterly reviews tied to growth metrics, and a joint success plan with measurable milestones.

- Named executive sponsors aligned to dmG leadership
- Monthly steering committee covering delivery and value realisation
- Quarterly Business Reviews (QBRs) tied to growth metrics
- Architecture and engineering working groups for technical alignment
- Executive briefings and roadmap access
- Joint success plan with measurable milestones

12-Month Governance Cadence



Customer Stories and Experience

Microsoft brings proven media and subscription industry experience, with playbooks and customer stories that directly parallel dmG's ambitions.

- Subscription growth playbooks refined across media customers
- Data activation at scale for consumer digital platforms
- High-traffic event readiness (proven at global sporting events)
- Security for consumer digital platforms
- Partner-delivered transformation at pace



NBC Olympics

Global streaming at scale



NFL

High-traffic event readiness



Dentsu

Data-driven media transformation



Measurable Success Indicators

Success is defined by measurable indicators across platform readiness, digital experience, experimentation velocity, data activation, subscriber outcomes, and unit economics.



Platform Readiness

Standard landing zone live and operational

↑ Target: Operational



Digital Experience

Improved availability and latency targets

↑ Target: Improved



Experimentation Velocity

Increased release frequency and shorter cycle times

↑ Target: Faster



Data Activation

Governed customer 360 datasets available in OneLake

↑ Target: Available



Subscriber Outcomes

Improved conversion, reduced churn, improved ARPU

↑ Target: Growth



Unit Economics

Clearer cost per subscriber with FinOps governance

↓ Target: Reduced Cost

News AI Customer Stories

As the world's largest provider of news on the desktop, Microsoft has for more than 25 years championed the importance of news to our audience of Windows users. We've collaborated closely with more than 1,200 media publishing partners, who represent more than 4,500 media brands. We distribute their stories via MSN and other Microsoft Start newsfeeds to hundreds of millions of readers in more than 180 countries and 31 languages.



Semafor
AI-enhanced breaking news

- Multi-Source Curation
- AI Assisted Research
- Structured Presentation
- Response to Social



Nota
Developing a custom language model
For newsroom tools

- Editors can refine tone and structure.
- Journalists benefit from faster turnaround and higher engagement.
- Newsrooms can maintain consistency and quality across content.



The Ground Truth Project
Localisation support

- Measure and track adoption attitudes in local newsrooms.
- Centralized project support



Le Monde

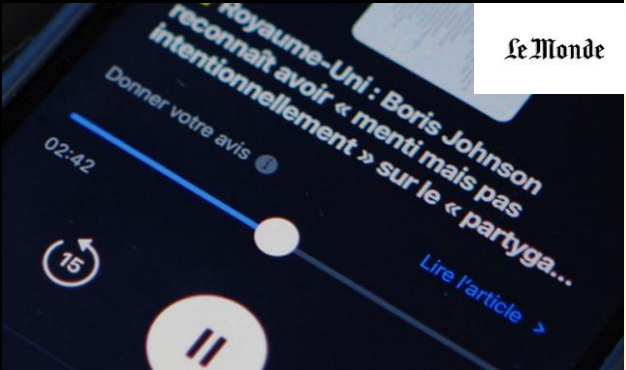
- Introducing Audio Articles powered by Azure cognitive services
- AI takes the literary style of Le Monde into account as well as the actors so the algorithm can integrate the full breadth of the paper's writing style.



Bye Bye, Busy Work

Journalists, editors and content creators of all sizes have better things to do than get bogged down with busy work. Nota's tool suite generates multipurpose content outputs and frees up hours of sweet sweet time. Check out the tools to see for yourself.

REQUEST A DEMO



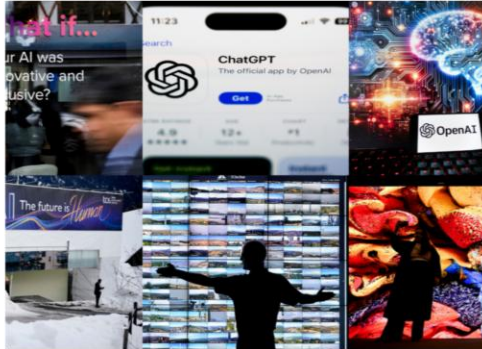
Le Monde



THE **groundtruth** PROJECT



DONATE



COLUMNS

The AI Revolution and what it means for local news

SEMAFOR

INTELLIGENT • TRANSPARENT • GLOBAL

Ben Smith and Gina Chua

Updated Feb 5, 2024, 4:33pm EST [SHARE](#)

Introducing Semafor Signals

SEMAFOR

SEMAFOR SIGNALS

US grounds Boeing 737 Max 9 planes over safety fears

With Insights from CNBC, The Atlantic, The New York Times, and Bloomberg



“We have already had 60 million users across our website and app so far this season. Fans all over the globe are positively engaging with the content being provided to them and enjoying the stories that come off of Premier League pitches up and down the country each match round.”

— Will Brass, Chief Commercial Officer, Premier League



Premier League drives deep fan connection with Microsoft Foundry and Azure Cosmos DB

Customer: Premier League

Country: United Kingdom

Industry: Sports and Live Experiences

Publish date: 11/2025

Size: 50-999 employees

[Watch the full story here](#)

Situation: To drive engagement and support personalized and contextually relevant fan experiences, the Premier League envisioned an agile, secure AI platform to connect its global fanbase with its vast compilation of match and team data, videos, and articles.

Solution: The Premier League unified massive, diverse datasets and enabled real-time, personalized fan experiences using Microsoft Azure AI, cloud, and analytics.

Impact: By enabling real-time personalization and rapid innovation, Premier League saw fan engagement rise 20%, with 60 million fans active in early months.

Products: Azure AI Foundry, Azure Cosmos DB, Azure, Azure Data Factory, Azure Databricks, Azure Machine Learning, Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry Models, Azure AI Search, Azure Managed Redis



Dentsu reduces time to media insights by 90% using Azure AI

Customer: Dentsu

Industry: Telecommunications

Size: 10,000+ employees

Country: United Kingdom

Publish date: 11/2024

[Read the full story here](#)

"It was great to get a head start with the scripts that were part of the Azure AI prompt flow template."

— Simon Ransom, Lead DevOps Engineer, Dentsu

Situation: Sophisticated media planning and budget optimizations require expertise from teams of data scientists and media analysts. But with insights taking weeks, Dentsu teams and clients needed faster answers and more self-service options.

Solution: Dentsu developers used Microsoft Azure AI Foundry and Azure OpenAI Service to build a predictive analytics copilot that uses conversational chat and draws on deep expertise in media forecasting, budgeting, and optimizations.

Impact: The new agent makes media insights available to more Dentsu employees and clients, cuts time to insight by 90%, and reduces analysis costs.

Products: Azure AI, Azure AI Studio, Azure API Management, Azure Kubernetes Service, Azure Machine Learning, Azure OpenAI Service, Microsoft Visual Studio



ESPN Edge finds a winning digital game plan in an evolving media landscape with Microsoft Azure

ESPN is a multinational sports media company that reached 74 million U.S. television households and averaged 108 million digital fans monthly in 2022.

Industry: Media & Comms

Size: Corporate (10,000+ employees)

Products: Microsoft Azure, Azure AI, Azure Analytics

Partners: Accenture, Verizon



Challenges

- ESPN wanted to continue to position itself as an innovative company to separate itself from competitors.
- The company knew that it had to cut through the noise of new media and tap modern technologies to create unparalleled fan experiences.



Solution

- ESPN worked with Microsoft, Accenture, and Verizon to launch the ESPN Edge Innovation Center, which brings together technology, consulting, connectivity, and hardware to develop new ways of experiencing sports.
- By using tools such as Azure AI, ESPN can provide automated, real-time closed captioning.



Impact

- Delivered more than 50% cost savings on closed captioning
- Captioned more content to serve sports fans
- Boosted operating margins
- Increased competitiveness in a changing media landscape

“Our Azure-based closed-captioning product will be at the forefront, providing innovative firsts to sports fans everywhere.”

Kevin Lopes, Vice President, Sports Business Development and Innovation at ESPN

[Read the Microsoft Customer Story](#)

NOTA

Customer:

Nota

Industry:

Media and Entertainment

Size:

1–49 employees

Country:

United States

Products and services:

Microsoft Azure
Azure OpenAI Service
Azure Machine Learning
Azure API Management

[Read full story here](#)



"Microsoft has shown us that we don't have to be a gigantic organization with a huge research and development lab to make exciting and meaningful AI applications."

—Josh Brandau, Chief Executive Officer, Nota

Situation:

To help struggling local newsrooms across America, Nota wanted to develop AI-assisted tools to help with a lot of the non-writing work that takes up much of journalists' time and pulls them away from their core job of investigating and reporting on the news.

Solution:

After connecting with the Microsoft for Startups Founders Hub, Nota saw the power of Azure OpenAI Service and has used it to create two applications that optimize written stories for social media distribution and turn those stories into engaging videos.

Impact:

User feedback during beta development has been extremely positive, and Nota has attracted the attention of many newsrooms—large and small. The company plans to build on its success with more solutions to help local journalists excel.

Microsoft Partner-Led Delivery

Backed by Microsoft Investment

*Accelerating outcomes with
Microsoft-backed, partner-led delivery*

SUPPORTED SCENARIOS



Cloud Migration
& Modernisation



Unified Data
& Analytics



AI-Enabled
Applications

What This Means For You

Microsoft enables qualified customers to accelerate cloud, data, and AI initiatives through partner-led delivery supported by Microsoft investments.



Reduce Delivery Risk

Proven frameworks and Microsoft architectural guidance mitigate project uncertainty.



Lower Upfront Cost

Microsoft investment alignment reduces the financial barrier to strategic initiatives.



Accelerate Time to Value

Pre-defined, outcome-driven engagements get you to production faster.

Partner-led programs and investments are available for qualifying engagements.

How Microsoft Supports Customer Success

End-to-end support across planning, delivery, and optimisation

Microsoft partner-led programs provide structured support across the full customer journey, combining partner expertise with Microsoft guidance and resources.



Proven Delivery Frameworks

Engagements aligned to Azure best practices, ensuring consistent, high-quality outcomes at every stage.



Architecture Guidance & Resources

Access to Microsoft technical resources and architecture guidance throughout your engagement.



Outcome-Driven Engagements

Accelerated delivery through pre-defined engagements designed to get you to production faster.

These programs are part of Microsoft's broader commitment to helping customers adopt Azure securely, reliably, and at scale.

Partner-led programs and investments are available for qualifying engagements.

Azure Accelerate

Supported scenarios

Core Migrate and Modernize

Migrate Windows Server, SQL Server, Linux and open source databases to Azure Virtual Machines, AzureSQL, Azure PostgreSQL, Azure CosmosDB, Azure MySQL

Modernization of existing applications to Azure
Securing the Azure environment with Microsoft Defender for Cloud

Migrate and Modernize VMware

Azure VMware Solution (AVS)

Migrate SAP

SAP RISE, SAP Native to Azure, SAP Grow

Migrate to Virtual Desktop Infrastructure (VDI)

Azure Virtual Desktop

Data Platform

Microsoft Fabric, Azure Databricks

AI Apps and Agents

Microsoft Foundry & Platform (Agents and Models), Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Azure App Service, Azure Open AI, Azure AI Services

Developer Productivity

GitHub Enterprise, GitHub Advanced Security, GitHub Copilot, GitHub Actions, GitHub Codespaces etc., plus complementary products

Other Scenarios

High performance compute (HPC), mainframe and midrange migration and Oracle migrations

New

Azure Accelerate

Azure Frontier Offer

Get started on AI, analytics and
database modernization projects



Expert help

Implementation assistance from Azure partners
for projects using Microsoft's Data and AI Platform

Support for Microsoft Foundry,
Microsoft Fabric and Azure databases



Partner funding

Up to **\$500K** funding to go toward project
implementation

(at **50%** of 1st year ACR)



Azure credits

Up to **\$500K** in Azure usage credits to help offset
initial run costs

(at **50%** of 1st year ACR)

Contact your Microsoft account team to get started

Additional purpose built offers for specific workloads and situations

Core Migrate and Modernize (and Incubation for cross Solution Play support)				
Offers Project size	Engagement activities	Partner funding	Azure credits	Engagement assistance
Azure VMware (Partner funding) >\$500K/year ACR Azure VMware Solution credits Any project size	Planning activities, including assessment or proof of value Implementation activities related to the stated workloads	Up to \$500K (Implement) (at 33% of 1st year ACR)	Up to \$350K (available for net new migrations only)	Partner and Microsoft CSU delivered
SAP RISE (partner funding) >\$50K ACR (for 3 years) SAP Azure Credit offer >\$100K ACR (for 3 years)	- Extend & Innovate proof of value - Implementation activities for migrating to SAP RISE	Up to \$50K (Plan) Up to \$500K (Implement) (at 33% of 3-year ACR)	Up to \$150K (at 33% of 3-year Reserved Instance value)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
Oracle Database@Azure offer >\$100K/year ACR	- Planning activities, including assessment or proof of value - Implementation activities related to deploying Oracle Database @Azure	Up to \$50K (Plan) (Assessments capped at \$20K) Up to \$500K (Implement) (at 33% of 1st year ACR)	N/A	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
Incubation workloads For HPC, mainframe/midrange and DevOps/Dev Box scenarios >\$50K/year ACR	- Planning activities, including proof of value - Implementation activities related to the stated workloads	Up to \$100K (Plan or Implement) (at 20% of 1st year ACR)	Up to \$100K (at 10% of 1st year ACR)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered

Azure Accelerate

Available via Microsoft field nomination only

Additional purpose built offers for specific workloads and situations

Core Migrate and Modernize (and Incubation for cross Solution Play support)				
Offers Project size	Engagement activities	Partner funding	Azure credits	Engagement assistance
Azure VMware (Partner funding) >\$500K/year ACR Azure VMware Solution credits Any project size	Planning activities, including assessment or proof of value Implementation activities related to the stated workloads	Up to \$500K (Implement) (at 33% of 1 st year ACR)	Up to \$350K (available for net new migrations only)	Partner and Microsoft CSU delivered
SAP RISE (partner funding) >\$50K ACR (for 3 years) SAP Azure Credit offer >\$100K ACR (for 3 years)	- Extend & Innovate proof of value - Implementation activities for migrating to SAP RISE	Up to \$50K (Plan) Up to \$500K (Implement) (at 33% of 3-year ACR)	Up to \$150K (at 33% of 3-year Reserved Instance value)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
Oracle Database@Azure offer >\$100K/year ACR	- Planning activities, including assessment or proof of value - Implementation activities related to deploying Oracle Database @Azure	Up to \$50K (Plan) (Assessments capped at \$20K) Up to \$500K (Implement) (at 33% of 1 st year ACR)	N/A	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
Incubation workloads For HPC, mainframe/midrange and DevOps/Dev Box scenarios >\$50K/year ACR	- Planning activities, including proof of value - Implementation activities related to the stated workloads	Up to \$100K (Plan or Implement) (at 20% of 1 st year ACR)	Up to \$100K (at 10% of 1 st year ACR)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered

Azure Accelerate

Available via Microsoft field nomination only

Additional purpose built offers for specific workloads and situations *(continued)*

AI Apps, Agents and Developer

Offers Project size	Engagement activities	Partner funding	Azure credits	Engagement assistance
Azure Frontier offer Any project size with >50% of ACR from one of these scenarios: • Data: Azure databases and/or Fabric • Platform: Foundry bundled w/Azure databases and/or Fabric	Implementation activities for deployment of solutions leveraging Azure databases (Azure SQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL and Cosmos DB), Microsoft Fabric and Microsoft Foundry	Up to \$500K (Implement) (at 50% of 1 st ACR)	Up to \$500K (at 50% of 1 st year ACR)	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
AI Transformation >\$5K/month ACR (AI workloads)	• AI capability envisioning workshop w/rapid prototyping • Landing zone architecture and implementation • Generative AI use case co-build and implementation Note: The funding is for customers who are dedicated to go on a full AI transformation journey through the 3-part framework the offer provides	Up to \$50K (Plan) Up to 500K (Implement) (at 20% of 1 st year ACR)	Up to \$125K (at 10% of 1 st year ACR)	Partner, Microsoft CSU and Microsoft ISD delivered
1:1 Hackathon >\$50K/year ACR Note: Available for Enterprise accounts only	Collaborative, developer-focused experience where experts guide to solve a specific customer use case/problem and/or introduce GitHub Copilot	Up to \$12K (Plan) – 1 day activity Up to \$24K (Plan) – 2 day activity (at 20% of 1st year ACR)	N/A	Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered

Data Platform

Offers Project size	Engagement activities	Partner funding	Azure credits	Engagement assistance
Synapse and HDInsight to Microsoft Fabric migration >\$15K/year ACR	Implementation activities to migrate Azure Synapse Analytics <i>or</i> Azure HDInsight workloads to Microsoft Fabric	Up to \$500K (Implement) (at 20% of 3-year ACR)	N/A	• Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered • Cloud Accelerate Factory supports Synapse dedicated pool scenarios
Databricks Compete Any project size (partner funding) >\$15K/year ACR (for Azure credits) >50% of ACR from Azure Databricks	Azure Databricks projects aiming to win against cloud competitors • Proof of value or other planning activities • Implementation activities related to Azure Databricks	Up to \$50K (Plan) Up to \$200K (implement) (at 33% of 1st year ACR)	Up to \$125K (at 10% of 1st year ACR)	• Partner or Microsoft ISD delivered
Analytics Modernization Accelerator >\$100K/year ACR	• Technical assessment of on-premises analytics workloads • Implementation activities, including ETL and data migration to Azure data stores and setup of Microsoft Fabric or Azure Databricks	Up to \$50K (Plan) Up to \$200K (Implement) (at 20% of 1st year ACR)	N/A	• Partner and Microsoft architects deliver